

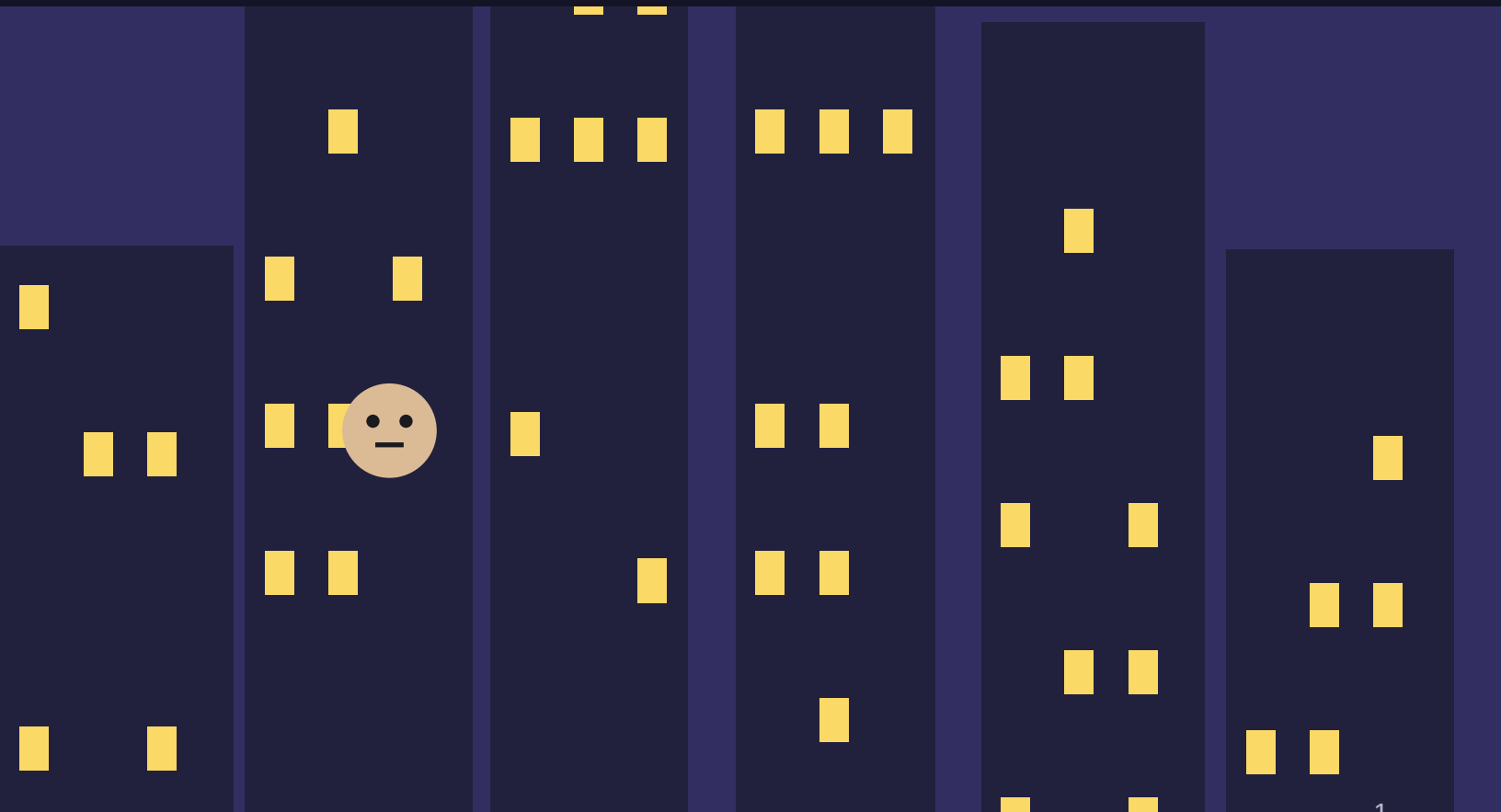


Finding a Small Star in the Crowd

picture by Echo



**The little star was small, its world vast
against the backdrop of a bustling city.**





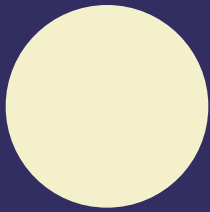
**Every day, it wandered through the
night's quiet, yearning for
connection--desiring to feel part of
something bigger than itself.**



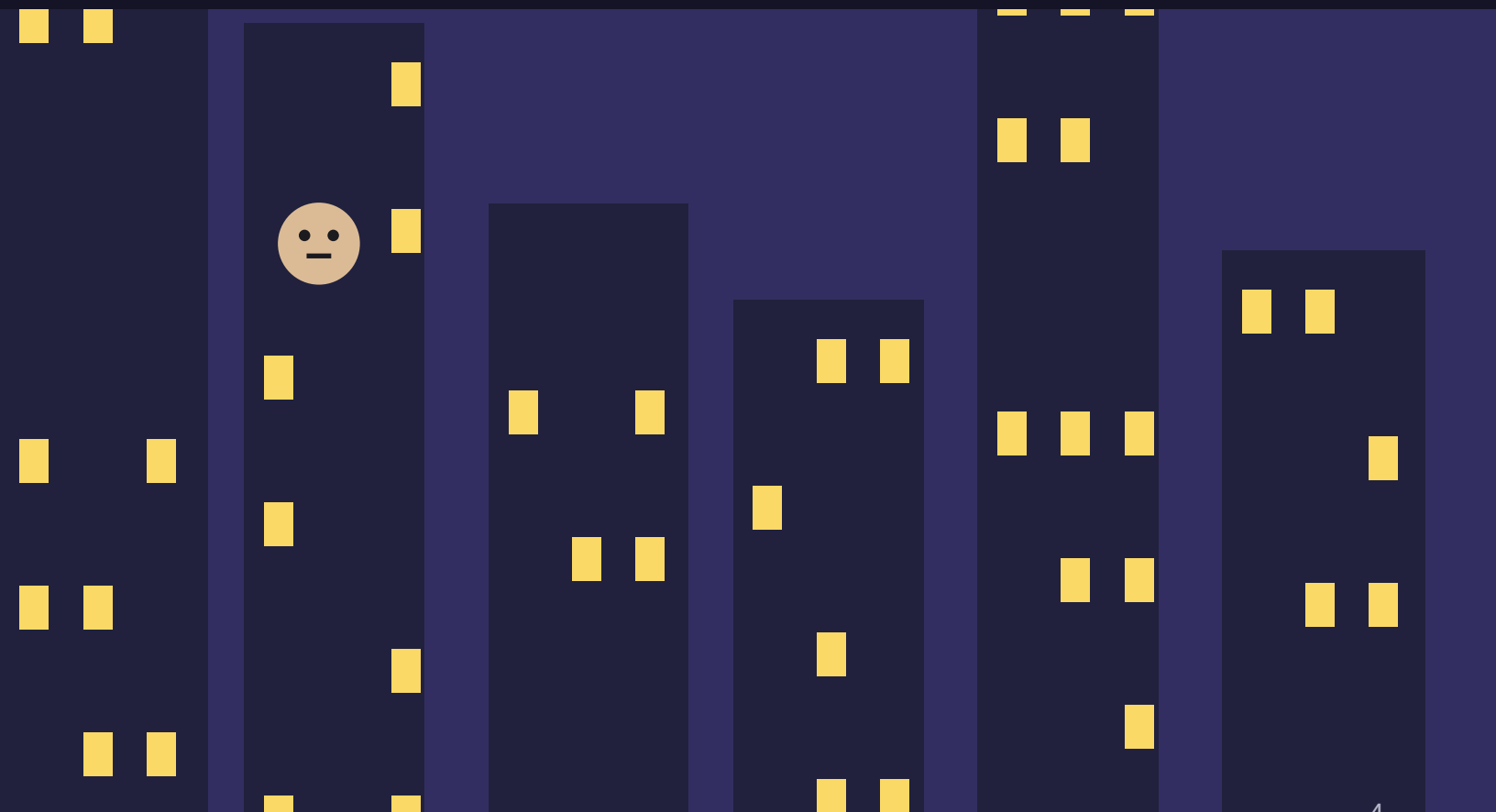


**But as dawn approached, everything
changed.**





**A hush fell across the city--a sudden
silence breaking only by echoes from
within.**





**Then the sky dimmed, casting shadows on
faces both familiar and alien.**





The little star was filled with a new determination: I am too small, it thought.





**Yet tiny or not, I'll try to make light
again.**





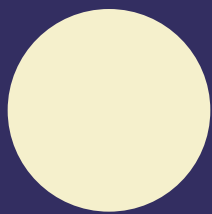
The night was long, but dawn broke with hope.





**The little star understood: not magic
existed here; only persistence born from
tiny hands reaching for stars.**





The End

you don't have to be big to matter